

ELMER ZONGYANG LI

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APPOINTMENTS

International Monetary Fund September 2024 – present
Economist (EP), Research Department (Structural and Climate Policies)

Pre-Doctoral Positions

Research Fellow, NYC Mayor’s Office for Economic Opportunity 2017–2018
Graduate Researcher, NYU Furman Center for Real Estate and Urban Policy 2016–2017
Summer Analyst, United Nations Development Programme Summer 2016
Chief Interpreter, City Government of Haikou, China 2014–2015

EDUCATION

Cornell University Ithaca, NY
Ph.D. in Economics 2024
M.A. in Economics 2021

Dissertation: “Labor Demand and the Macroeconomy.”

Committee: Philipp Kircher, Julieta Caunedo, and Michael Lovenheim.

New York University New York, NY
Master of Public Administration 2017
Specialization: Public Finance and Financial Management.

RESEARCH FIELDS

Macroeconomics, Labor Economics, International Trade, and Industry Dynamics.

WORKING PAPERS

1. “Occupational Skill Mixing Under Breakthrough GPTs.” [\[Paper\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#)
2. “E-Commerce Expansion and Regional Disparities: Evidence from Amazon’s Distribution Facilities.” (with Ruiqi (Rachel) Sun). [\[Paper\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#)
3. “New Skills, Higher Pay? Evidence from Job Postings.” (with David Koll and Marina M. Tavares). [\[Paper\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#)
Media coverage: *Financial Times*, *World Economic Forum*, *Fortune*, and the *IMF Blog*.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

1. “Bridging Skill Gaps for the Future: New Jobs Creation in the AI Age.” (with Florence Jaumotte, Jaden Kim, David Koll, Longji Li, Giovanni Melina, Alina Song, and Marina M. Tavares). *IMF Staff Discussion Note*, 2026.
2. **Vietnam: “Boosting Productivity and Medium-Term Growth in Vietnam.”** *IMF Selected Issues Papers*, No. 284 (2025); IMF Country Report No. 25/284. [\[link\]](#)
3. **South Africa: “Growth Benefits of Macro-Structural Reforms in South Africa.”** *IMF Selected Issues Papers*, No. 023 (2025); IMF Country Report No. 25/29. [\[link\]](#)

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. **“Buy versus Build: The Impact of Firm Acquisition on New Skill Demand.”** (with Alina Jiajing Song, Marina M. Tavares, and David Koll).
2. **“When New Technologies Come to Town: Evaluating the Impact of Skill Diffusion.”**
3. **“The Quantity-Quality Tradeoff of Employment and Labor Share Effects of Monetary Policy.”**
4. **“The Rise of the Dollar and the Decline of Business Dynamism.”** (with Wentong Chen).
5. **“Household Debt, Firm Mark-up and Mark-down.”** (with Shihan Shen).

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

- 2026.** Singapore Management University[†], University of Hong Kong[†], Rocky Mountain Empirical Trade Conference[†], Harvard Kennedy School[†], Bank of England[†], University of Maryland[†], University of Cambridge[†], IMF Jobs and Growth Seminar, IMF Asia and Pacific Department.
- 2025.** ASSA/AEA Annual Meeting, Chinese Economic Society (CES) North America Conference, LACEA Annual Meeting, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting.
- 2024.** IMF Research Department, Search and Matching Workshop Asia-Pacific (NUS), Wake Forest University, Norwegian School of Economics (NHH), Amherst College, Monash University, Tilburg University, Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Dongbei University of Finance and Economics (IAER).
- 2023.** Labor / Firms / Macro Workshop (UPenn), Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting, European Economic Association Annual Congress, ASSA/AEA Annual Meeting, Urban Economics Association Meeting, Eastern Economic Association Conference.
- 2022 and earlier.** Southern Economic Association Meeting, Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics (AASLE), Economics Graduate Student Conference (WUSTL), Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (Philadelphia Fed), Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting, Midwest International Trade Conference, CIREQ Graduate Student Conference, Cornell Labor Work-in-Progress Seminar, Cornell Macroeconomics Lunch Seminar.

† Presented by a coauthor.

HONORS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

Laura Bassi Publication Accelerator Grant, Bassi Foundation	2023
AEA and CIREQ Meetings Travel Grants	2022–2023
Small Grant in Labor Economics, Cornell University	2020
Lucy Maltby Fellowship, Cornell University	2018
Human Service Studies Graduate Fellowship, Cornell University	2018
Ruth Ada Birk Eastwood Scholarship, Cornell University	2018
Mabel Rollins Scholarship, Cornell University	2018
Association for Education Finance and Policy Travel Grant	2018
Department of Economics & Brooks School Travel Awards (×5), Cornell University	2018–2024
Ellen Schall Summer Grant, New York University	2016
First National Award in English Public Speaking, Ministry of Education of China	2012

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Prof. Philipp Kircher, Cornell University	2022
Prof. Pauline Leung, Cornell University	2021
Prof. Julieta Caunedo, Cornell University	2020
Prof. Warren Brown, Cornell University, and Prof. Sarah Hamersma, Syracuse University	2019–2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Cornell University

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory — TA for Prof. Philipp Kircher	Spring 2023
Introductory Macroeconomics — TA for Prof. Jennifer Wissink	Fall 2021, Fall 2022
Multiple Regression Analysis — TA for Prof. Nicolas Botton	Spring 2022
Behavioral Economics and Public Policy — TA for Prof. Brandon Tripp	Fall 2020, Spring 2021
Intermediate Policy Analysis — TA for Prof. Rick Geddes	Spring 2020
Economics of the Public Sector — TA for Prof. Brandon Tripp	Fall 2019

New York University

Microeconomics — Tutor for Prof. Sewin Chen	Fall 2016
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PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Mentor, Fund Internship Program, International Monetary Fund	Summer 2025
Judge and Selection Committee Member, Cornell Undergraduate Research Board	Spring 2024
Mentor, DEI Program for PhD Students, Cornell Brooks School	Summer 2023
Mentor, Graduate Mentoring Program, Cornell Economics Department	Summer 2023
Graduate Field Representative, Cornell Graduate Student Association	2019–2020
Vice Chair, Wagner Economics and Finance Association	2016–2017
Mentor for Underrepresented Students, NYC Urban Assembly Academy	2015–2016

ADDITIONAL TRAINING AND CERTIFICATIONS

Macro Finance Summer School, Princeton University	2024
Certificate in Data, Statistical Inference and Modeling, Duke University	2015
Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) Level I (passed)	2015
Certified Accounting Professional of China	2013
Exchange Student, University of Hong Kong	2013
Exchange Student, Chinese Culture University, Taipei	2012

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming: MATLAB, Stata, R, SAS, ArcGIS, and Tableau; familiar with Python and SQL.

Languages: English (fluent); Mandarin Chinese (native).

Last updated: May 2026.